

Tidal Hunters — Lore Bible (Draft)

Light reorganization and copyedit only. WIP placeholders preserved.

1. Premise

God came back and explained that he is just a higher dimensional being. He didn't create Earth but found it, and threw some proteins here from another galaxy, and we were born. He says humans have advanced enough that we don't need help from what he was protecting us from. But he said he is a living being and has gotten bored, so he will be taking on another challenge in whatever type of life he is. So he leaves us. No rapture, no answer to death, just more confusion.

About a year after this happened, small dark-colored pools that looked like ponds of void started popping up in some countries with deep religious culture. Eventually, at one of the larger ones, a large eldritch beast emerged from it and caused destruction and lots of death as it tried to feed off our organic matter. This is the start of the Hunters era.

2. Historical Timeline

- **The God Event:** God returns, reveals himself as a higher dimensional being, explains humanity's origin, says humanity no longer needs protection, and leaves.
- **+1 Year:** Voidpools appear, mostly in countries with deep religious culture.
- **Hunters Era Begins:** A large eldritch beast emerges from a larger voidpond and causes mass destruction and death.
- **Nazeda Rises:** Nazeda hires contracted fighters to fight the beasts emerging from the portals. Beasts become more prevalent. Nazeda gains funding and fame for standing up.
- **A-Meg Era:** Nazeda builds its company around the pools. It designs the A-Meg, a Type A Mega Structure: beautiful, luxurious, built for rich people to live and create a community if beasts get out of control. It fills up fast.
- **Backlash:** People complain: why do the rich get to live while everyone else dies?
- **B-Meg Era:** Nazeda develops B-Megs, Type B Mega Structures: larger, 2nd gen, meant to handle entire countries and areas inside their walls while contained. Cheap, strong, and quick to build. Governments contract them over the next few years.
- **The Great Moving:** Entire countries of people move into these structures. This was about 150 years ago.
- **Unrest:** People become unhappy. Travel is reduced from country-to-country to one side of a structure to the other. Most world travel is cut off.
- **Beast Ramp-Up:** Beasts ramp up. This moves almost all people inside, other than stubborn farmers and people who refuse to leave home.
- **The Tunnel Network:** Nazeda builds huge machines and manufactures huge tunnels at all B-Megs. Goal: interconnect all the close ones, then the ones under the seas. Machines burrow deeper than Earth's crust. A new polymer resists high temperatures closer to the inside of the

Earth. Large tunnels and track use geothermal heating to propel moles through the ground. The system and track are already built. The moles move and navigate them.

- **~100 Years Ago:** Beast fishing is figured out.
- **~70 Years Ago:** Betting on hunters becomes popular. Nazeda tests betting drones, then introduces them across the B-Megs.
- **~50 Years After Fishing:** Nazeda begins developing synthetic hunters using human brain samples and woven human tissue.

3. Nazeda

Nazeda owns everything hunter- and Mole-related.

- Order a flag? It comes neatly folded in a Nazeda Box.
- Order a weapon? It comes in a Nazeda-stamped case.
- Everything comes from Nazeda.

Nazeda developed the A-Megs, B-Megs, Moles, tunnel systems, synthetic hunters, and betting drones. They take a small commission from betting.

4. Voidpools & Beasts

- Voidpools look like small, dark ponds of void.
- They appeared in countries with deep religious culture.
- Larger voidpools can release large eldritch beasts.
- Beasts try to feed off organic matter.
- Beasts show their 4th-dimensional self.
- Hunters can damage, hurt, and scare off beasts, but never kill them until they pull the root out.

5. Megastructures

A-Meg

- Stands for Type A Mega Structure.
- Beautiful and luxurious.
- Built for rich people to live and create a community with each other if beasts get out of control.
- One was built, and it filled up fast.

B-Meg

- Stands for Type B Mega Structure.
- Larger, 2nd gen megastructure.
- Meant to handle entire countries and areas inside their walls while contained.
- Developed quickly: cheap, strong, easy to build.
- Governments contracted them to be built over the next few years.
- Entire countries of people moved into these structures.
- They are so large you could get lost in them and end up miles away from your home.

- One of the most popular jobs is construction worker, building up more of the structure at the outside.
- There is much to do inside, and it rewrote most of culture.
- It was almost like the second cultural upbringing of humans. They learned to live and learned to love.
- People got used to close communities.
- Different sections of each megastructure have influences of cultures from the past.

6. Moles & Tunnel Network

The system and track are already built. It's the moles that move and navigate them.

If a hunter buys a brand-new mole, it is quite large. It has:

- ****Shopping Terminal:**** Buy guns, attachments, armor, grenades, fishing items, and sigils (flags).
- ****Equip/Modify Terminal:**** Choose primary weapon, secondary, attachments, armor, etc. It has a very Helldivers 2 feel.
- ****Movement/Mission Terminal:**** Select the area you want to go to, and select the voidpond in that area.

Next inside the moles is the front, which shows the tunnels. It is usually just a dark moving tunnel you can see, but at hubs you can see much more. Most hunters access their weapons and have shops in these hubs. Usually a crew shares a mole, but the best hunters have their own. There are some civilians with moles, but they must use commercial transport to move around the world.

7. Hunter Equipment & Beast Fishing

About 100 years ago, we figured out beast fishing.

The beasts would show their 4th-dimensional self, which we could damage and hurt and scare off, but never kill until we pulled the root out. We did that using extremely large fishing rods ****[Need Name]****. They range from 15–25 feet in length.

- They all have a flag attach point.
- Every single hunter wears one on their back.
- It is a huge part of the hunter silhouette.
- They are thick, and the reel takes up a large part of back space, but it is necessary.
- They are made of the same polymer as moles for the most part.
- They usually have a hollow bone core near the handle, which has a crystal induced with ****[WIP Name]**** using advanced science techniques that use organic matter and crystals to interact with higher dimensions.
- Because of its organic nature, at first only humans could get a beast out.

- They have to do it one at a time. If multiple people hold the pole or hook into the same beast, it will scare or tear from conflicting energies.

About 50 years after we found fishing, Nazeda began developing robots to help fight beasts. They needed unpredictability and the ability to fish, which robots can't do. So they grew human brain samples in a lab and human tissue which they wove into the machine, and it stays alive. They are complicated and can fish. Not as strong as a human, but they can do it. They also have a human brain in them and are like organic computers.

The oldest ones are some of the most loved hunters. They develop personality, and a lot of them feel like Pathfinder from Apex. New bots have fresh programs and are not fun to watch. The most experienced hunter squads all have their robot buddy. **[Need new name instead of "robots"]**

8. Flags / Sigils

[Need word before "Flags"] Flags

These attach to the rods. They fly high on the backs of hunters, representing either a clan or an individual. They are unique and a recognizer. They are also woven with interdimensional resonant fiber, which allows beasts to see the hunters better and keeps their interest.

9. Beast Fighting

Fishing is just the beginning. The beast's core fights back. It's not profitable to just put guns that automatically kill them when they come up, so hunters fight them with rifles, shotguns, SMGs, and LMGs.

Typically a squad has:

- Machine gunner
- Rifleman
- Shotgunner
- CQB specialist

A nice spread to work with anything that comes out. The fights are often long, intense, and dangerous. Beast fighting is the core of this world and the core of the gameplay.

10. Betting & Drone Culture

Around 70 years ago, many people started placing small bets on hunters and how it would go:

- Who would pull the root up
- Who would get mad at who

- Who would land the first blow
- Who would land the last
- Who would die
- Etc.

Nazeda noticed this and tested out betting drones which followed hunters in the field when they were working beasts. The test went extremely well, so they introduced it into the rest of the B-Megs. Now it's the thing. Almost everyone does it. Nazeda takes their small commission.

The drones shoot fireworks for donations and sponsors and all that stuff. They can also leave messages to the hunters. It's a whole culture, and you can get really famous if you do well with the people.

11. Gameplay Loop & Inspirations

- Squad up with friends.
- Go to an arena.
- Initiate a fight.
- Sell stuff at your mole to buy better gear.
- Helldivers 2 community-style advancements would be cool.
- HD2 feel to the equipment terminal.

12. Open Naming / WIP

- Fishing rods: **[Need Name]**
- Crystal induction substance: **[WIP Name]**
- Robot hunters: **[Need new name]**
- Flags: **[Need word before "Flags"]